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NEWSPAPER

6th July, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

27th WEEK



NORTH KOREA & USA

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

6th JULY, 2017

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Missile diplomacy

The U.S. needs to be inventive in responding to the North Korean provocation

In early January, Donald Trump, then the U.S. President-elect, tweeted that North Korea would never develop a "nuclear weapon capable of reaching parts of the U.S.". But Pyongyang appears to have done exactly that, defying warnings issued by Washington. Tuesday's test of an intercontinental ballistic missile, that appears to be capable of striking Alaska, poses perhaps the greatest foreign policy challenge so far before Mr. Trump. And he appears to be lost for an effective response. While senior officials of the Trump administration have consistently talked tough, they have banked heavily on China, North Korea's most crucial political and economic ally, to rein in its missile programme. Mr. Trump had even offered China a better trade deal for its help in addressing the crisis and appreciated President Xi Jinping's efforts. But neither the tough posturing nor banking on China's help seems to have worked, and Kim Jong-un, North Korea's Supreme Leader, remains as defiant as ever. Washington's response to the missile test was typical. The U.S. and South Korea immediately conducted missile exercises to counter "North Korea's destabilising and unlawful actions", and the State Department asked for more UN sanctions on the North.

But had sanctions and threats been effective as a strategy, Mr. Kim would not have carried out the ICBM test in the first place. Ever since he took power in 2012 he has steadily expanded North Korea's missile programme; challenging the U.S. is central to his foreign policy doctrine. All these years the U.S. has stepped up sanctions and taken an incrementally harsher line towards the Kim regime. Mr. Trump has simply followed the Obama administration's stick-and-sanctions policy towards the North, but with a China emphasis. But he is now back to square one, with very few options. Though the administration has said all options are on the table, even a limited military strike would be dangerously risky. Given the unpredictability of the Kim regime, any attack could be tantamount to a declaration of war on the Korean peninsula. Another option is to continue the tested-and-failed policy of sanctions and international isolation, which would mean more trouble for the North Korean people with an uncertain effect on the

THE  HINDU

Date : 6th July, 2017



RUSSIA

MONGOLIA

NORTH KOREA

Korea bay

Sea of Japan

Tsushima Strait

North Pacific Ocean

South Korea

Yellow Sea

CHINA

JAPAN

East China Sea



NUCLEAR TEST BY NORTH KOREA

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ABOUT NORTH KOREA

- Name is Democratic People's Republic of Korea
- Capital Pyongyang
- Language ... Korean
- Currency ... Won
- Population ... 25 million
- It is in East Asia
- It has got land boundary with 3 countries i.e., China, Russia & South Korea
- Armistice of 1953 ended armed conflict in Korean peninsula

HEADS / SUPREME LEADERS



KIM II-SUNG
(1948-1994)



KIM JONG-IL
(1994-2011)



KIM JONG-UN
(since 2011)



OTHER ASPECTS

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- 1 It is one of the world's most secretive societies
- 2 It rigidly maintained isolation from the rest of the world
- 3 China is its closest ally and it is the main exporter to North Korea
- 4 There are news reports that systematic human rights violations are taking place
- 5 State controlled economy led to stagnation and it is totalitarian state
- 6 North Korea conducted its first nuclear test in October 2006
- 7 The Country is under strict sanctions of the United Nations
- 8 Export of coal, iron & iron ore used for its nuclear or missile programmes is banned
- 9 The present Supreme Leader is known for his unpredictable behaviour

2

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NEWS REPORT

- North Korea tested Intercontinental Ballistic Missile that appears to be capable of striking Alaska.
- Initially President Donald Trump thought that North Korea could never develop a nuclear weapon capable of reaching parts of USA.
- Now, it developed an Intercontinental Ballistic Missile capable of striking Alaska, which is a region of America.

So far USA is relied on China but, China is not containing North Korea deliberately.



ALASKA
USA

CANADA

UNITED STATES

North
Pacific
Ocean

Caribbean Sea



NORTH KOREA AND USA SINCE 1990s



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- 1** Regime acceptance and regime survival have been key priorities for North Korea, since the collapse of the Soviet Union.
- 2** In 1992, a positive move was the withdrawal of tactical nuclear weapons from the Korean Peninsula and suspension of Team Spirit, the joint U.S.-South Korean military exercises.
- 3** This led to the Basic Agreement on Reconciliation, Non-Aggression and Exchanges and Cooperation.
- 4** However, in 1993, when joint exercises were resumed, North Korea announced its decision to withdraw from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).
- 5** However, North Korea was persuaded to suspend its decision to withdraw from the NPT.
- 6** North Korea also agreed to freeze its nuclear activities, and in return, the U.S. pledged to build two light water nuclear power reactors.
- 7** Food aid and humanitarian assistance was provided by the Clinton administration from 1995 till 2000 was close to \$750 million.



WHAT WENT WRONG SINCE 2000?



- 1** The Bush administration declared North Korea as part of the 'Axis of Evil' in 2002.
- 2** It also cancelled direct talks and annulled 1994 agreement.
- 3** North Korea responded by throwing out International Atomic Energy Agency inspectors and formally leaving the Non-Proliferation Treaty, thereby provoking a fresh crisis.
- 4** China and Russia initiated Six Party Talks in 2004, which led to the 2005 joint statement, which expanded the scope to more than the nuclear issue.
- 5** However, the talks collapsed when the U.S. imposed sanctions a few months later.
- 6** North Korea responded with its first nuclear test in 2006.



IAEA

International Atomic Energy Agency



WHY CHINA IS NOT CONTAINING NORTH KOREA?



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1 China is pretty sure that North Korea will not target its weapons on China.

2 In fact, China is not happy with USA as it is interfering in the territorial dispute of South China Sea.

3 USA's decision to deploy THAAD (Terminal High Altitude Area Defense) anti-ballistic missile system in South Korea is further infuriating China.

4 If North Korea collapses, millions of refugees may pile up in China, for which China is not ready.

5 If North Korea collapses, ultimately with USA's help, Unified Korean Peninsula may become a reality, which China never like it in its backyard.



RUSSIA

MONGOLIA

KOREAN PENINSULA

Korea bay

Sea of Japan

Tsushima Strait

North Pacific Ocean

Yellow Sea

JAPAN

CHINA

East China Sea

WHAT ARE THE OPTIONS LEFT OUT?**1**

*Limited military strike
on North Korea*

2

*Increasing more and
more sanctions and
international isolation.*

3

*Holding direct
negotiations with
Pyongyang.*

In South Korea, Donald Trump has got a counterpart Moon Jae-in, who is more inclined in addressing the issue through diplomacy and discussion with North Korea. It appears to be the best option but also herculean task in view of the increased hostilities.

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar
V. Dayakar James
Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

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